



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## Ransomware Groups Abuse VPN and Edge Vulnerabilities Daily Threat Report

Threat Report

|                       |                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Ransomware Groups Abuse VPN and Edge Vulnerabilities Daily Threat Report - Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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# Ransomware Groups Abuse VPN and Edge Vulnerabilities Daily Threat Report

## 1. Executive Summary

Late-July reporting highlights ransomware actors continuing to prioritize VPN and edge-security products including Palo Alto, Fortinet, Citrix, and Check Point. This is a daily operational priority because vulnerable remote-access infrastructure remains one of the fastest paths from internet exposure to extortion staging.

This 2026-07-29 daily report turns the source coverage into an operator-ready defensive brief with sector relevance, exposure paths, detection signals, and hunt queries.

## 2. Intelligence Requirements

| Question                        | Current Answer                                                                                | Confidence |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| What happened?                  | Ransomware groups are prioritizing remote-access and edge flaws.                              | Medium     |
| Who should care?                | Network, IAM, SOC, and incident-response teams that own VPN/firewall/ADC exposure.            | Medium     |
| What should defenders do first? | Inventory edge products, patch exploited flaws, and hunt for suspicious VPN/session activity. | High       |

## 3. Source Review & Confidence

| Source                                              | Contribution                                                                               | Confidence |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| CybersecurityNews ransomware gangs attack VPN flaws | Current article describing ransomware abuse of VPN and security-appliance vulnerabilities. | Medium     |
| Help Net Security ransomware trends 2026            | Recent context on ransomware victim growth and supply-chain/AI-driven tactics.             | Medium     |
| CISA KEV catalog                                    | Authoritative exploited-vulnerability prioritization source.                               | Medium     |

## 4. Threat Activity Overview

The activity should be handled as an exposure-management and identity-defense problem: appliances need emergency patching, but defenders also need session review, impossible-travel checks, new administrator hunting, and post-auth lateral movement detection.

## 5. Affected Sectors and Exposure

| Exposure Area                 | Operational Relevance                                                                          |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity and remote access    | Review MFA, session theft, VPN, SSO, and privileged-account controls.                          |
| Endpoint and server telemetry | Hunt for suspicious child processes, script interpreters, archive staging, and unusual egress. |

|                                    |                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Third-party and supply-chain paths | Validate vendor access, software dependencies, and shared service-provider incident assumptions. |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## 6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

| Tactic / Phase      | Observed or Plausible Technique                                  | Evidence / Rationale                                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial Access      | Phishing, exposed services, supply-chain trust, or vendor access | Source coverage emphasizes enterprise entry points and shared dependencies.                                |
| Execution           | Script or payload execution                                      | Defenders should look for command interpreters, suspicious child processes, and package/runtime execution. |
| Collection / Impact | Data theft, credential abuse, extortion, or disruption           | The covered activity creates confidentiality, integrity, and availability risk.                            |

## 7. Infrastructure and Indicators

| Indicator / Observable                                                   | Type              | Operational Use                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Source-reported infrastructure/IOCs                                      | Reference         | No hard IOCs were copied unless explicitly available; review cited primary sources before blocking. |
| Topic keywords: vpn, ransomware, fortinet, palo alto, citrix, checkpoint | Hunt pivot        | Use in proxy, EDR, ticketing, and vulnerability-management searches.                                |
| Unusual admin/tool execution after relevant exposure                     | Behavioral signal | Prioritize for triage and scoping.                                                                  |

## 8. Detection Engineering

| Signal                                                            | Telemetry Source                         | Analytic Goal                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Suspicious process execution following exposure to this activity. | EDR / audit logs                         | Identify follow-on execution or hands-on-keyboard activity. |
| Unusual outbound connections from affected assets.                | DNS, proxy, firewall, EDR network events | Surface callback, exfiltration, or staging behavior.        |
| Account changes or new tokens near incident window.               | IAM, SSO, SaaS audit logs                | Detect persistence and privilege abuse.                     |

```

title: Daily Threat Priority Suspicious Script Follow-On Activity
status: experimental
logsource:
  product: windows
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\curl.exe'
  condition: selection
level: medium

```

## 9. Threat Hunting

Hypothesis: assets exposed to this threat theme should show a time-correlated pattern of suspicious command execution, network egress, or account-control changes.

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("vpn", "ransomware", "fortinet", "palo alto", "citrix",
"checkpoint") or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ("vpn", "ransomware", "fortinet", "palo alto",
"citrix", "checkpoint")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, AccountName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessFileName
| order by Timestamp desc

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ("vpn", "ransomware", "fortinet", "palo alto", "citrix",
"checkpoint") or RemoteUrl has_any ("vpn", "ransomware", "fortinet", "palo alto", "citrix",
"checkpoint")
| summarize Connections=count(), FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), LastSeen=max(Timestamp) by DeviceName,
RemoteUrl, RemoteIP, InitiatingProcessFileName
| order by Connections desc
```

## 10. Risk Assessment

| Dimension  | Assessment                                                                                                                                          |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Likelihood | Medium: source coverage indicates relevant activity or exposure, but local exposure depends on asset inventory.                                     |
| Impact     | Medium to High: identity, supply-chain, aviation operations, or edge-service compromise can have outsized operational effects.                      |
| Confidence | Medium: source set includes current public reporting plus supporting context; defenders should validate against primary advisories where available. |

## 11. Recommended Actions

| Priority | Owner                 | Action                                                                                                  |
|----------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Critical | Asset / service owner | Confirm whether the covered product, supplier, platform, or sector exposure exists in your environment. |
| High     | SOC                   | Run included KQL hunts and pivot on source-specific keywords.                                           |
| High     | Third-party risk      | Validate vendor controls and shared-service dependencies when relevant.                                 |
| Medium   | Detection engineering | Convert the behavioral signals into environment-specific analytics with tested telemetry fields.        |

## 12. References

- [1] CybersecurityNews ransomware gangs attack VPN flaws — <https://cybersecuritynews.com/ransomware-gangs-attack-vpn/>
- [2] Help Net Security ransomware trends 2026 — <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/24/ransomware-attack-trends-2026-report/>

- [3] CISA KEV catalog — <https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>